

Paid Ad Teardown

I'm The Chef Too vs. Raddish Kids and Baketivity

Pulled live from the Meta Ad Library and Google Ads Transparency Center. Active ads only, no ad account or spend required.

Executive summary

- I'm The Chef Too owns a real point of difference: STEM through baking. No competitor claims it. The problem is the claim gets stated far more often than it gets shown.
- Baketivity, not Raddish, is the brand to watch. It is testing two offers at once, uses kid voiceovers for authenticity, and leads its Google ads with a specific star rating instead of a vague trust number.
- Every brand in this set leans on a big headline number (families served, boxes shipped, ratings). That move has been copied so many times it barely registers anymore.
- Raddish's strongest asset, a free first month, is sitting in small text under its videos where almost nobody will read it.
- The fix for both platforms is the same idea in two forms: get specific. Name the exact skill a kid learns on Meta. Lead with a specific, checkable number on Google.

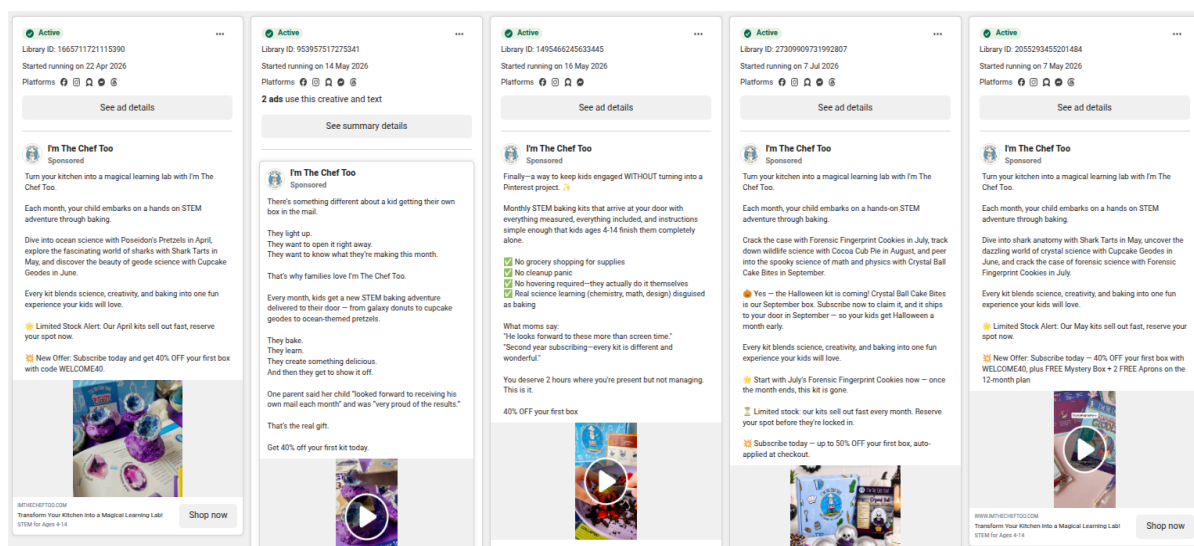
Methodology

This teardown looks at three kids' cooking and baking subscription brands: I'm The Chef Too (the client), Raddish Kids, and Baketivity. Baketivity is the closer rival of the two competitors; it runs the same monthly-kit format at the same age range and leans on the same STEM-adjacent framing. Raddish is worth including too, even though it doesn't compete on STEM at all. It sells the same core mechanic, a themed kit that shows up once a month, but wins on a completely different promise: family time and turning picky eaters into curious ones. Seeing a brand succeed with almost the opposite pitch is useful context on its own.

Every ad below is currently live. They were pulled straight from the Meta Ad Library, which needs no login or ad account, and the Google Ads Transparency Center, searched by domain to sidestep any mismatch between a brand name and its legal entity. Each one was logged for its hook, its offer, the visual style, the call to action, and, where Meta shows it, how long the ad has been running. An ad that's been live for months is a decent proxy for "this is working": nobody keeps paying for a loser.

I'm The Chef Too (Client)

Meta Ads



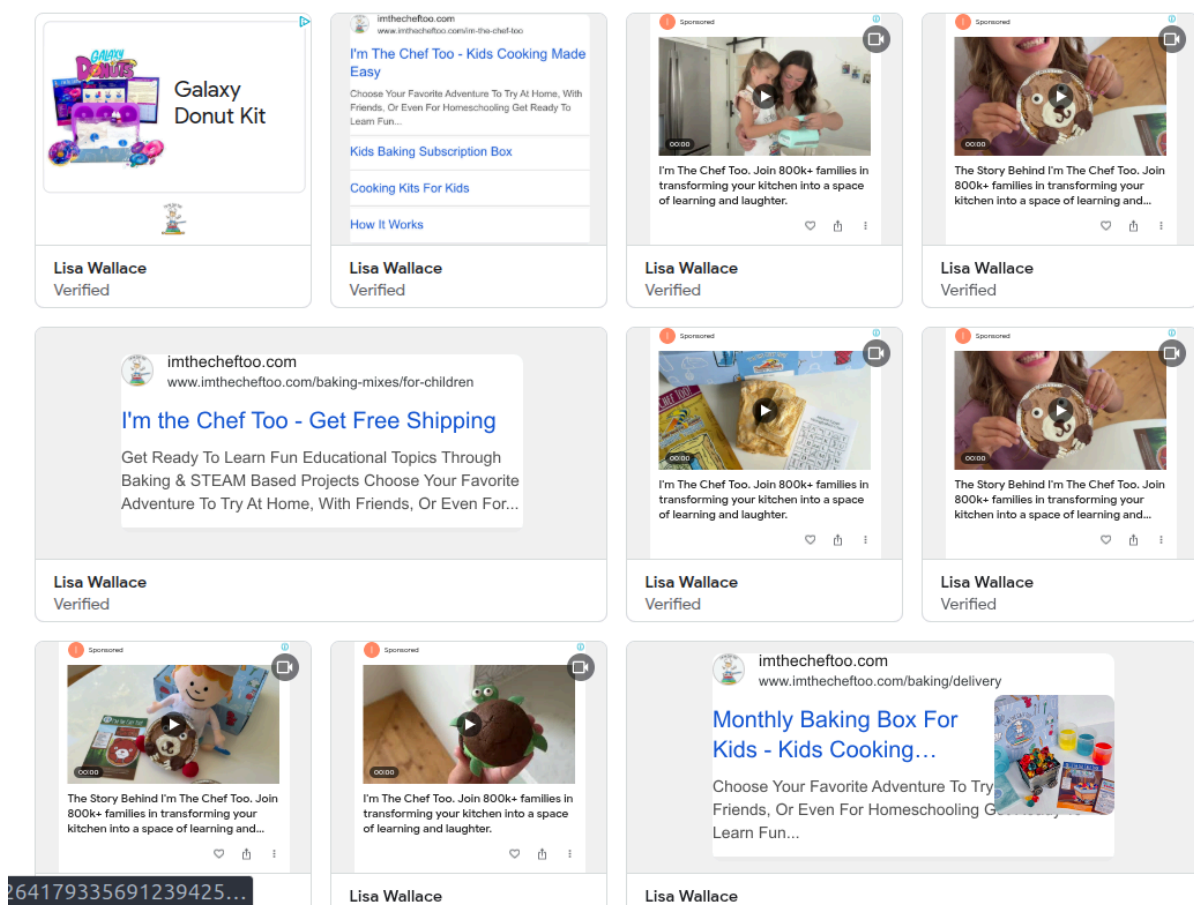
I'm The Chef Too — active Meta Ad Library results

Started	Theme / Hook	Offer	Notes
Apr 22	Ocean/shark/geode kits, fixed 'magical learning lab' line	40% off first box (WELCOME40)	Scarcity: kits sell out fast
May 14	Unboxing/monthly reveal	40% off first kit	Parent testimonial quote; 2 ad variants running on this same creative, a sign it's a proven winner
May 16	Anti-'Pinterest mom' pain point	40% off	Checklist of pain points solved; short testimonial lines
Jul 7	Forensic/Halloween, seasonal	Up to 50% off, auto-applied at checkout	Urgency: 'once the month ends, it's gone'
May 7	Multi-theme recap (shark, crystal, forensic)	40% off + free mystery box + 2 free aprons on the 12-month plan	Bigger incentive tied to a longer commitment

The 40% number is the baseline; the site's own subscription page currently advertises "up to 50% off your first kit," while its email opt-in still shows a flat 40%. So the 50% figure isn't a separate offer, it looks like a seasonal bump for Halloween timed to the same kind of urgency the July ad leans on (*once the month ends, it's gone*).

One line does most of the work across these ads: *"Turn your kitchen into a magical learning lab..."* It reappears every month with only the theme swapped out. The discount barely moves either, but what does change is the *second lever paired with it*: a parent testimonial when the ad's job is reassurance, urgency copy when it's seasonal, bonus items when the goal is locking someone into the 12-month plan.

Google Ads



I'm The Chef Too — active Google Ads Transparency Center results

- A set of video ads, different thumbnails, all reusing the line "Join 800K+ families in transforming your kitchen into a space of learning and laughter." Pure trust and social proof.
- A second, separate video set built around "The Story Behind I'm The Chef Too," a brand-origin angle.
- One search ad leads with free shipping as the offer, a different lever than anything running on Meta.
- A second search ad leads with "Choose Your Favorite Adventure" and calls out homeschooling directly, with sitelinks to How It Works and Kids Baking Subscription Box.

Google skews toward trust-building and plain clarity (how it works, free shipping, homeschool fit) instead of the discount-forward approach on Meta. That split makes sense: someone searching on Google is closer to a decision already and wants reassurance more than a hook.

A detail worth correcting from the raw notes

ITCT's Meta videos show a kid actually baking with a parent present, and the voiceover in most of them is the mother's, not the child's; that authenticity device belongs to Baketivity, not ITCT. ITCT's videos gesture at STEM outcomes with broad claims like improved STEM grades, but they don't name the specific concept a kid learns in a given video. That's a small but real gap, and it shows up again in the pattern summary below.

Shipping, quickly

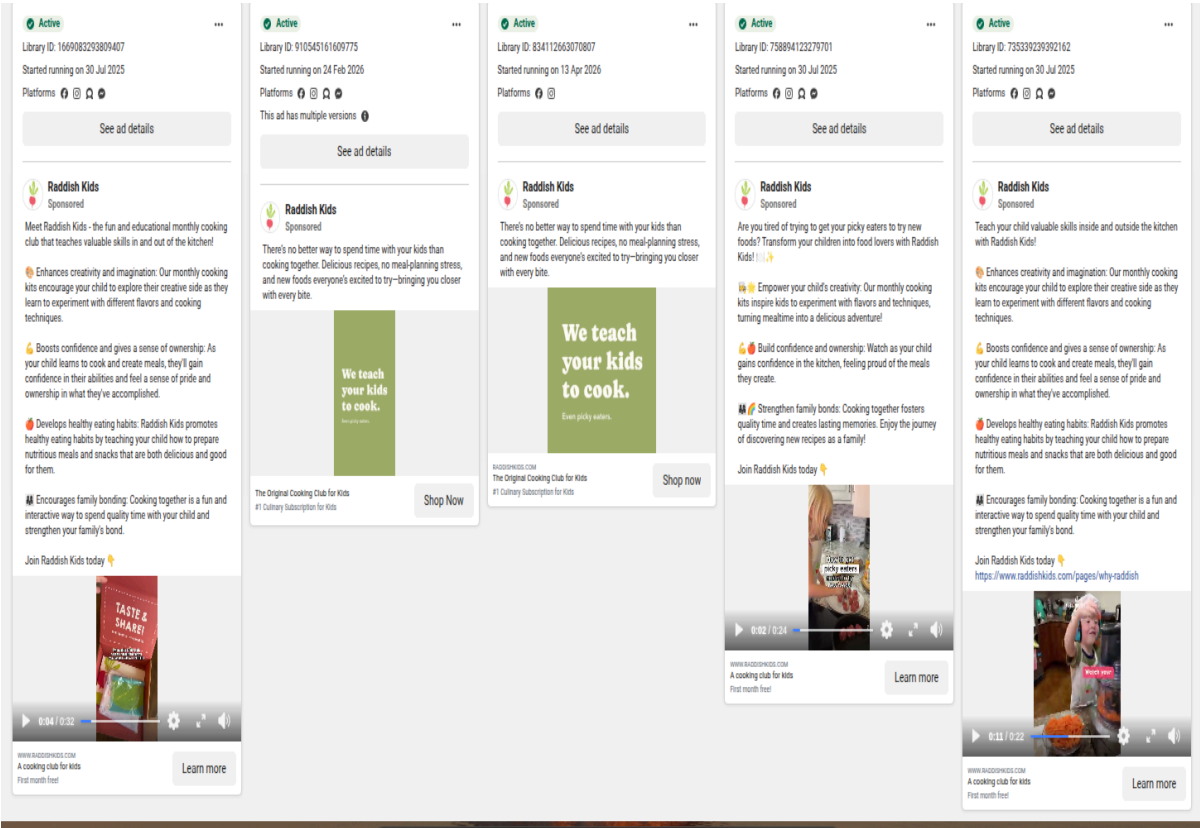
ITCT leads with "FREE US Shipping!" as a stated line in its ads. Baketivity does the same ("Free shipping in USA"). Raddish never mentions shipping anywhere in what we pulled. It's a small thing, but it means free shipping is close to

table stakes for two of the three brands, and a gap worth confirming for Raddish before assuming it's simply absent from their strategy.

Competitor: Raddish Kids (Adjacent)

Not a head-to-head STEM rival, but worth studying anyway: it sells the same monthly-kit mechanic to the same kind of buyer and proves a genuinely different value proposition can work in this category.

Meta Ads

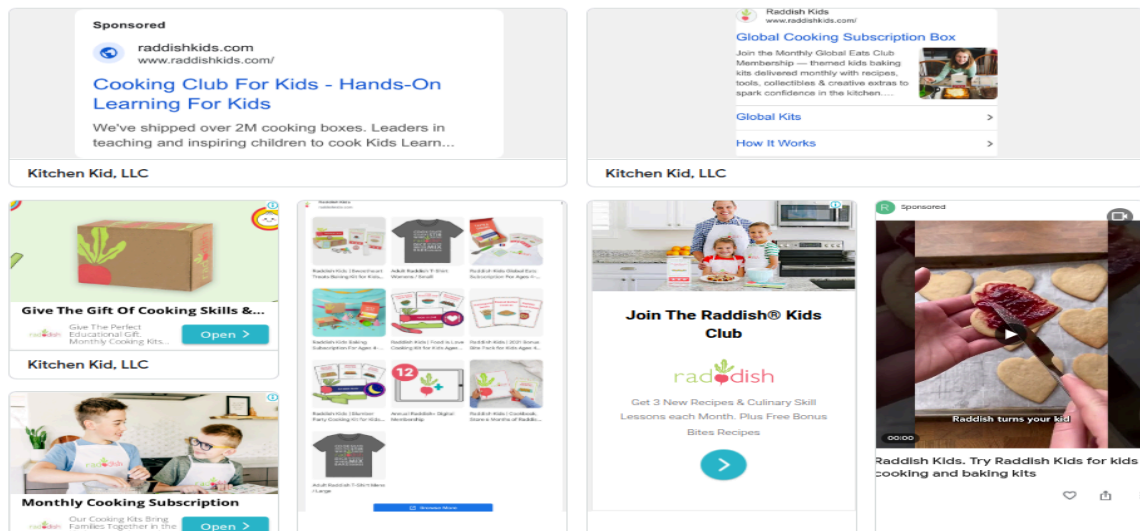


Raddish Kids — active Meta Ad Library results

Started	Format	Message	Offer
Jul 30 '25	Video	Full benefit list: creativity, confidence, healthy eating, family bonding	"First month free!" (small text)
Feb 24 '26 / Apr 13 '26	Flat text-on-color graphic, no product shown	"We teach your kids to cook," reused across 2 ad variants	None visible beyond "#1 Culinary Subscription"
Jul 30 '25	Video, testimonial-style	Picky-eater pain point	"First month free!"
Jul 30 '25	Video	Skills + family bonding	"Learn more," no offer shown

Raddish is the only one of the three competing on *risk reversal* (try it free) rather than a price cut, the opposite lever from ITCT and Baketivity. Right now it's easy to miss: the free-month offer sits in small text under the video instead of leading the ad. The two flat text-on-color graphics, no product shown at all, are the most generic creative anywhere in this set.

Google Ads



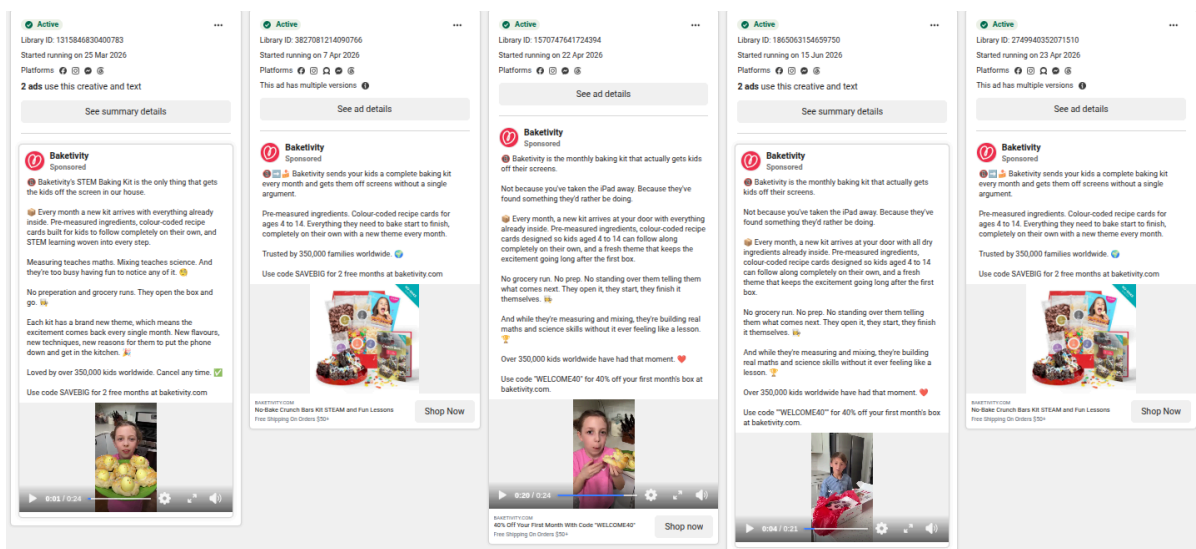
Raddish Kids — active Google Ads Transparency Center results

- Search headline: "Cooking Club For Kids, Hands-On Learning For Kids," backed by a claim of 2M+ cooking boxes shipped, the biggest volume number of the three brands.
- A "Global Cooking Subscription Box" listing runs the same monthly-theme mechanic as ITCT, just without the STEM label attached.
- Shopping and display units lean into gifting ("Give the Gift of Cooking Skills") and merch cross-sell, plus a 12-month membership tier.

Raddish's real edge over ITCT isn't the offer or the creative, it's the positioning. It owns the *emotional, relational, picky-eater angle* with zero STEM claim anywhere. That reads as a deliberate choice, not a gap.

Competitor: Baketivity (Closest Direct Rival)

Meta Ads



Started	Hook	Offer	Notes
Mar 25 / Apr 23	"Only thing that gets kids off the screen"	SAVEBIG, 2 free months	Trust line: 350,000 families worldwide
Apr 7	Same 'off screens, no argument' hook	SAVEBIG, 2 free months	Reused creative and copy
Apr 22 / Jun 15	"Not because you've taken the iPad away..." plus the STEM mechanism shown on screen (measuring = math)	WELCOME40, 40% off first month	Kid-voiceover video; emotional beat: 350K kids "have had that moment"

Baketivity is running two offer structures at the same time: *2 free months (SAVEBIG) against 40% off the first month (WELCOME40)*, an active test neither ITCT nor Raddish appears to be running. It also puts kids on the voiceover, which nobody else in the set does on Meta, and it's the only brand that actually shows the STEM mechanism instead of just asserting it: "measuring teaches math, without it feeling like a lesson."

Google Ads

The collage displays nine Google Ads for Baketivity, organized in three rows of three. Each ad includes a visual element (product image or video thumbnail), a headline, a description, and a rating. The ads are all verified by Baketivity Corp.

- Top Row:**
 - Ad 1: "Children's Baking Kits - Cooking..." with a product image.
 - Ad 2: "Baketivity - Kits for Kids Ages 3 to 12 - Step-by-step recipe" with a list of offerings: One Time Baking Kits, Baking Kits For Kids, Kids Baking Subscription Box, Duff Kits, and Live Baking Classes.
 - Ad 3: "A World Baking Tour at Home. An at-home summer baking camp. Bake through four countries with pre-measured kits."
- Middle Row:**
 - Ad 4: "Award-Winning Kids Cooking - For Kids Ages 4-14" with a description: "A great way to foster creativity, problem-solving skills, and a love of food in children. Subscriptions renew automatically..." and a rating of 4.8 stars (2,129 reviews).
 - Ad 5: "Baketivity Kids Baking Kits. STEM baking kits with every ingredient pre-measured and five monthly classes included."
 - Ad 6: "Cookings Kits For Children - 4.9 Stars. 350,000 Happy Kids" with a description: "The award-winning baking kit that builds real confidence and skills in kids ages 3 to 12. Rated 4.9 stars by..."
- Bottom Row:**
 - Ad 7: "Children's Baking Kit - Cooking..." with a product image.
 - Ad 8: "Children's Baking Kit - Cooking..." with a product image and a "-24%" discount tag.
 - Ad 9: "Cookings Kits For Children - 4.9 Stars. 350,000 Happy Kids" (repeated from the middle row).

Baketivity — active Google Ads Transparency Center results

- Star ratings sit directly in the search snippet: 4.8★ (2,129 reviews) and, elsewhere, 4.9★ / 350,000 happy kids, a sharper and more checkable trust signal than either competitor's headline number.

- Sitelinks reveal a broader product ladder than ITCT or Raddish: One Time Baking Kits, a Kids Baking Subscription Box, a Duff Kits partnership line, and Live Baking Classes, so there are several entry points, not just a subscription.
- Age range runs 3–12 on the site and 4–14 in the ads, a slightly wider net than ITCT's fixed 4–14.

Baketivity is the most sophisticated operator of the three: it's actively testing offers, its creative leans on authenticity rather than polish, its trust signals are specific and checkable, and its product line isn't locked into one commitment level. It's the brand ITCT should be watching most closely, not Raddish.

Pattern Summary: Generic vs. Working

Recycled across the whole category (generic, not a differentiator for anyone)

- "Family bonding through cooking" as a stated benefit. All three brands claim it somewhere.
- Monthly themed kits, pre-measured ingredients, a no-mess promise. This is the category's core mechanic, not a point of difference.
- A big trust number up top (ITCT: 800K+ families · Raddish: 2M+ boxes shipped · Baketivity: 350K families / 4.8-4.9★). Everyone runs some version of this now, so the number alone has stopped doing much persuasive work. It's table stakes.
- First-box discount codes: ITCT and Baketivity are both running close to the same ~40%-off-first-month mechanic.
- The unboxing-plus-kid-using-the-product video format, present in some form across all three.
- Free shipping, called out explicitly by ITCT and Baketivity; Raddish never mentions it, which either means it's genuinely absent or just untested as a message.

What's actually working, brand by brand

- ITCT owns STEM-through-baking as a specific, ownable claim, sharper than Raddish's general "learning" language. But right now it's stated ("STEM learning woven in," "improves STEM grades") more often than it's shown.
- Baketivity shows the mechanism instead of just naming it, "measuring teaches math, without it feeling like a lesson," and pairs that with kid-voiceover authenticity and live offer-testing between SAVEBIG and WELCOME40.
- Raddish is the only brand competing on risk reversal (a free trial) instead of a price cut, and the only one making zero STEM claim, a clean, deliberate differentiation even though its execution currently buries the offer that makes it work.

A gap shared by both STEM-forward brands

ITCT and Baketivity both claim STEM is happening, but neither one consistently names the exact concept in the moment it's taught. Baketivity's "measuring teaches math" line gets closest, and even that only shows up in a subset of its ads. ITCT leans on broader, harder-to-verify claims like improved STEM grades rather than pointing at what's being learned in that specific box. Naming the concept directly, something like "today your child learns fraction math by measuring 3/4 cup of flour," would be a stronger, more concrete proof point than anything either brand is currently running, and neither has claimed it yet.

Stand-Out Recommendations

Meta / TikTok: the hook and the creative carry it

Build the hook around one specific, named STEM concept, demonstrated by a real kid on camera, instead of a category-generic line like "magical learning lab." A simple structure: the kid says in their own words what they just learned ("I just learned fractions by measuring flour") right before the finished bake gets revealed. That does two things at once. It borrows Baketivity's authenticity move, a kid's voice reads as more trustworthy than a brand voiceover, while closing the exact gap flagged above, since naming the specific concept is something neither direct competitor

does consistently. It also gives ITCT a hook that isn't just another version of the discount-plus-testimonial format every brand here is already running.

Google: clarity and the offer win

Swap the brand-story headline for a specific, checkable proof point placed directly in the ad copy: a star rating and review count (Baketivity's 4.8★ / 2,129 reviews is the number to beat), or a concrete outcome stat tied to the STEM claim, something like a specific skill or concept count per box. Someone searching with real intent usually has two or three tabs open side by side, and the ad with the most concrete, skimmable credibility in that moment wins, not the one telling the best story. The 800K+ families number can stay as supporting evidence further down, but it shouldn't be the first thing the ad says, since every competitor is already running some version of a big headline number.

One more thing worth testing

Raddish's "first month free" offer is sitting in small text under its videos right now, easy to miss even on a close read. If ITCT ever tests a free-trial offer alongside its flat discount, Raddish's placement is a useful example of what to avoid: lead with the offer, don't bury it under the fold.